

Rewriting India's Beauty Story

Young Indian consumers are no longer buying beauty to look like someone else. They are buying it to understand themselves

BY SAKSHI BATRA

INDIA'S BEAUTY AND cosmetics industry is undergoing a quiet yet powerful transformation. What once revolved around celebrity endorsements and one-size-fits-all beauty ideals is now being redefined by creators and the community.

Gone are the days when you would see only movie stars on billboards endorsing beauty brands. The new face of beauty is a YouTuber explaining ingredients, a 'reel'

creator testing products in real time, or a micro-influencer from a Tier II city decoding skincare routines in a regional language.

ASPIRATION TO INFORMATION

Young Indian consumers are no longer buying beauty to look like someone else. Ingredient-led skincare, retinols, niacinamides, ceramides, peptides and sunscreens have replaced vague promises of 'fairness' or 'instant glow'. Doc-

tors, dermatologists and skin care experts are regularly using social media platforms to raise awareness, which was previously only available to those who could afford experts.

"Young Indians now are fully aware of skincare and home devices and are open to preventative care and treatments for their concerns," says Dr Kiran Sethi, Celebrity Dermatologist & Director of Isya Aesthetics. "Younger generation does ask tougher ques-

THE RISE OF BEAUTY

▶ **India's beauty industry is undergoing a fundamental shift from celebrity-driven aspiration to creator-led authenticity**

▶ **Young Indians no longer buy beauty to "look like someone else" but to understand their own skin and hair**

▶ **Young consumers are willing to spend but demand value, transparency, and performance**